

TB Volume

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Overview

Adjusts level precisely while keeping the stereo image stable and protecting output peaks.

What this plug-in solves

A simple gain stage is useful for automation, trim, and level matching, but many utilities surround it with metering and routing that slow down basic work. TB Volume keeps one underlying level value and allows it to be viewed in dB or an equal-loudness-inspired percent scale without changing the sound when modes switch.

What you can expect

- Fast and repeatable level trim
- Mode switching without a gain jump
- Clean automation of one normalized control
- Stereo-linked peak protection in the deployed design

How it works

TB Volume is a controlled gain stage for precise level changes. It adjusts loudness while keeping the relationship between the stereo channels stable, making it suitable for automation, matching sections, or creating clean fades without adding tone.

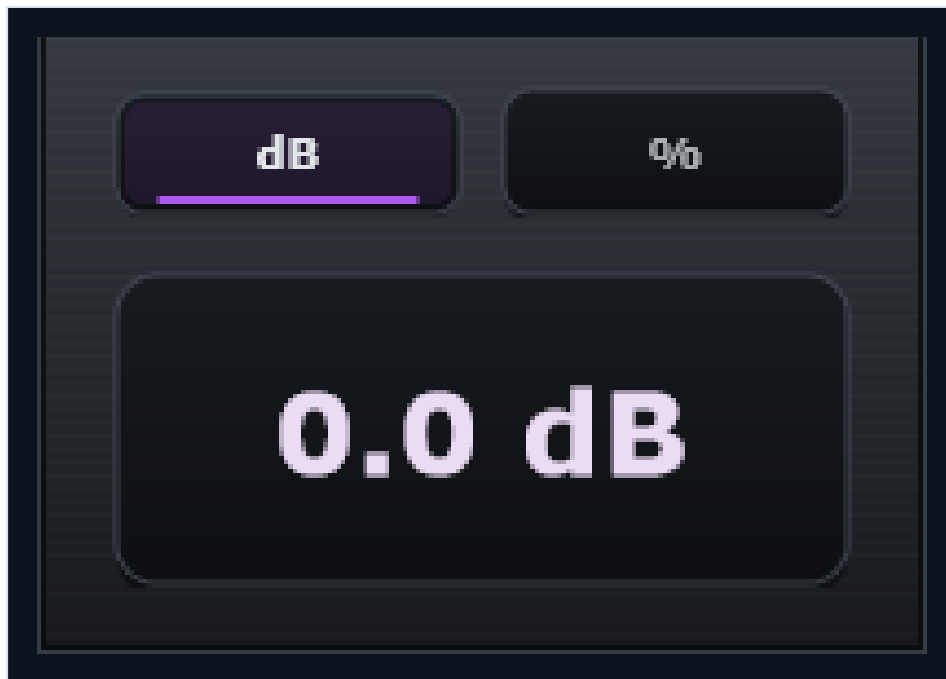
Choose the operating mode that matches the task, set the desired level, and use peak protection when the change could create new overloads. Judge the result in the full mix: a technically equal reading can still feel different depending on the arrangement and the material around it.

Quick start

- 1 Choose dB or percent display.
- 2 Set the level while monitoring the downstream bus.
- 3 Use bypass for a true level comparison.
- 4 Write automation on Normalized Level.

- 5 Leave headroom; do not rely on peak protection for routine gain staging.

Interface and key sections



This is a direct capture of the current plug-in interface. Use the visible labels to locate the areas and controls explained below.

Mode

dB mode uses a conventional gain display, while percent mode presents the same underlying level in a simplified scale. Changing Mode changes the presentation, not the current audio level.

Normalized Level

Normalized Level is mapped by the selected display mode. Its center position is the neutral reference, so changing the display does not create a gain jump.

Peak protection

The deployed design includes stereo-linked sample-peak protection with short lookahead near full scale. Treat it as safety, not as a mastering limiter.

Automation

Automate the normalized level for fades and scene changes. Because both display modes address the same value, do not expect separate automation lanes for dB and percent.

Controllable properties

The guide uses the names shown on the plug-in panel. Each explanation describes the audible result, a useful way to approach the control, and an important interaction to listen for.

Control	What it does and when to use it
Bypass	Turns the complete effect off or on for a direct before-and-after comparison. Compare with bypass at a similar loudness. If the effect creates a tail, let that tail settle before judging the difference.
Mode	Chooses how the plug-in or current section behaves. Compare the available characters on the same short passage. Choose by the musical result rather than by the name of the mode.
Normalized Level	Sets the output level on a simple zero-to-one scale when percent-style control is preferred. Move it gradually and listen for the point where the intended result becomes clear without introducing a new problem elsewhere.

Practical uses

Level matching

- Place TB Volume after the processor being evaluated.
- Adjust level until bypassed and processed loudness match.
- Make the tonal decision only after matching.

Expected result: Comparisons reflect processing character rather than louder-is-better bias.

Simple fade

- Choose the preferred display mode.
- Automate Normalized Level from silence to the target.
- Use the DAW curve shape to define the fade.

Expected result: A clean stereo-linked fade is created with one automation lane.

Common pitfalls

Peak protection is not true-peak mastering control. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.

Percent is a display mapping, not linear perceived loudness for every source. Return the strongest control toward neutral, compare with bypass at a similar loudness, and add the processing back one section at a time.

Large boosts raise the noise floor and downstream processing level. Reduce the main amount, feedback, drive, or input first, then rebuild the sound while watching the output meter and listening after the source stops.